STARTER PACK

Welcome: start here

خوش آمدید

This pack has what you need for the first week: an alphabet chart, a vowel-marks card, and Unit 1 (the first six letters).



1 Print

- A4 paper, portrait, “actual size”. Black and white is fine.
- Pencils (HB) and a rubber for the child. A soft pencil is easier to trace with.

2 Sit down

- 10 minutes, once a day. Stop while the child still wants more.
- Sit on the child’s left so your hand does not hide the page.

3 Remember three things

- Urdu goes **right to left**. Start on the right of the page.
- Letters **join**, and change shape. The chart shows all the shapes.
- **Body first, dots last.** Write the whole word, then add the dots.

4 What is inside

1. Alphabet chart in teaching order (2 pages)
2. Vowel marks card
3. Unit 1: guide, trace sheets for the six letters, look-alikes, join the letters, reading practice, unit check, answer keys

More sheets for every unit are in the app, under Practice sheets.

Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

1 alif
الف
'a' in father when long
ا
ـا (end)

2 be
بے
'b' in bat
ب
ـب (end) · ـبـ (middle) · بـ (start)

3 kāf
کاف
'k' in kite
ک
ـک (end) · ـکـ (middle) · کـ (start)

4 lām
لام
'l' in log
ل
ـل (end) · ـلـ (middle) · لـ (start)

5 mīm
میم
'm' in mat
م
ـم (end) · ـمـ (middle) · مـ (start)

6 nūn
نون
'n' in net
ن
ـن (end) · ـنـ (middle) · نـ (start)

7 te
تے
soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth
ت
ـت (end) · ـتـ (middle) · تـ (start)

8 choṭī ye
چھوٹی ے
'y' in yes at the start
ی
ـی (end) · ـیـ (middle) · یـ (start)

9 baṛī ye
بڑی ے
'ay' in day
ے
ـے (end)

10 pe
پے
'p' in pat
پ
ـپ (end) · ـپـ (middle) · پـ (start)

11 ṭe
ٹے
hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back
ٹ
ـٹ (end) · ـٹـ (middle) · ٹـ (start)

12 ṣe
ثے
's' in sun
ث
ـث (end) · ـثـ (middle) · ثـ (start)

13 wāʾo
واؤ
'w'/'v' at the start
و
ـو (end)

14 re
رے
tapped 'r'
ر
ـر (end)

15 dāl
دال
soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth
د
ـد (end)

16 choṭī he (gol he)
ہے / گول ہے
'h' in hat
ہ
ـہ (end) · ـہـ (middle) · ہـ (start)

17 sīn
سین
's' in sun
س
ـس (end) · ـسـ (middle) · سـ (start)

18 shīn
شین
'sh' in shop
ش
ـش (end) · ـشـ (middle) · شـ (start)

19 jīm
جیم
'j' in jam
ج
ـج (end) · ـجـ (middle) · جـ (start)

20 che
چے
'ch' in chair
چ
ـچ (end) · ـچـ (middle) · چـ (start)

21 gāf
گاف
'g' in go
گ
ـگ (end) · ـگـ (middle) · گـ (start)

Alphabet chart: the order we teach

حروفِ تہجی

39 letters. Each card: the letter alone, then its shape at the start, middle and end of a word (read from the right).

22 nūn g̱hunna
نون غنہ
nasalises the vowel before it, like French
ں
ـں end

23 do-chashmī he
دو چشمی ہے
a puff of breath after the letter before
ھ
ـھ end ـھـ middle ھـ start

24 ḍāl
ڈال
hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back
ڈ
ـڈ end

25 ṛe
ڑے
a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue
ڑ
ـڑ end

26 ze
زے
'z' in zoo
ز
ـز end

27 zhe
ژے
's' in pleasure
ژ
ـژ end

28 fe
فے
'f' in fat
ف
ـف end ـفـ middle فـ start

29 qāf
قاف
a 'k' made far back in the throat
ق
ـق end ـقـ middle قـ start

30 k̲he
خے
'ch' in Scottish loch
خ
ـخ end ـخـ middle خـ start

31 g̱hain
غین
a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'
غ
ـغ end ـغـ middle غـ start

32 ‘ain
عین
in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel
ع
ـع end ـعـ middle عـ start

33 baṛī ḥe
بڑی حے
'h' in hat
ح
ـح end ـحـ middle حـ start

34 ṣwād
صاد
's' in sun
ص
ـص end ـصـ middle صـ start

35 ẓwād
ضاد
'z' in zoo
ض
ـض end ـضـ middle ضـ start

36 ṭo’e
طوے
soft 't'
ط
ـط end ـطـ middle طـ start

37 ẓo’e
ظوے
'z' in zoo
ظ
ـظ end ـظـ middle ظـ start

38 ẕāl
ذال
'z' in zoo
ذ
ـذ end

39 hamza
ہمزہ
a tiny break between two vowels
ئ
ـئ end ـئـ middle ئـ start

Vowel marks and signs

حرکات

The small marks are written above or below a letter. They tell you the short vowel. We keep them in every word until unit 11.

بَ

zabar زبر

short a (as in 'but')

بَس

bas · enough

بِ

zer زیر

short i (as in 'bit')

دِل

dil · heart

بُ

pesh پیش

short u (as in 'put')

گُل

gul · flower

بْ

jazm (sukūn) جزم

no vowel after this letter

سَبْزی

sabzī · vegetable

بّ

tashdīd تشدید

double the letter

بچّہ

bachcha · child

بٰ

khaṛā zabar کھڑا زبر

long ā without alif

اعلیٰ

a'lā · high

Long vowels

Letter	Sound	Example	Reads as
ا	ā	کام	kām
آ	ā (word start)	آم	ām
ی	ī	تین	tīn
و	ū	جوتا	jūtā
و	o	روٹی	roṭī
ے	e	لے	le
ے	ai	ہے	hai
و	au	اور	aur
ی	ai (mid-word)	میں	maiṉ

Numbers

۹	۸	۷	۶	۵	۴	۳	۲	۱	۰
9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0

Signs

۔ full stop · ، comma · ؟ question mark · ؛ semicolon

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

1 In this unit



Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ن م ل ک ب ا

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ا	**alif** الف 'a' in father when long	one stroke, top to bottom	lām
ب	**be** بے 'b' in bat	start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last	nūn
ک	**kāf** کاف 'k' in kite	base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top	none yet
ل	**lām** لام 'l' in log	tall stroke down, curve into the bowl	alif
م	**mīm** میم 'm' in mat	small loop, tail down-left	none yet
ن	**nūn** نون 'n' in net	deep round bowl; dot last	be

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.

Trace and write: alif

الف

Name _____ Date _____

alif الف



Sound: 'a' in father when long

the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: one stroke, top to bottom.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone

Again, alone

End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)

From memory: write it alone

In a word: ab (now)

آب

Trace and write: be

بے

Name _____ Date _____

be بے



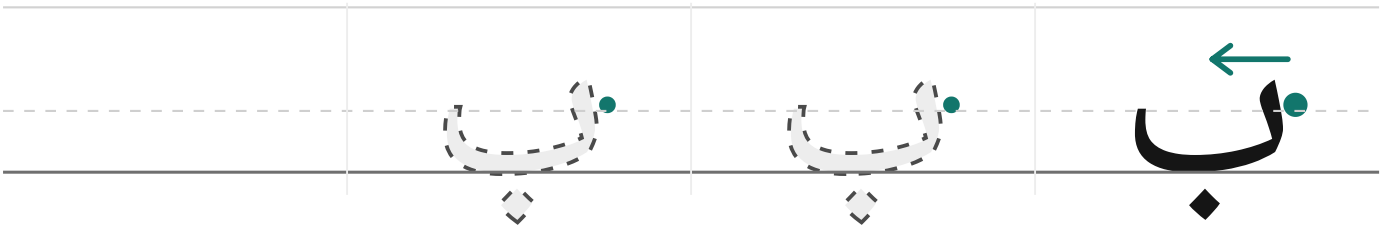
Sound: 'b' in bat

step 1: the body | step 2: 1 dot

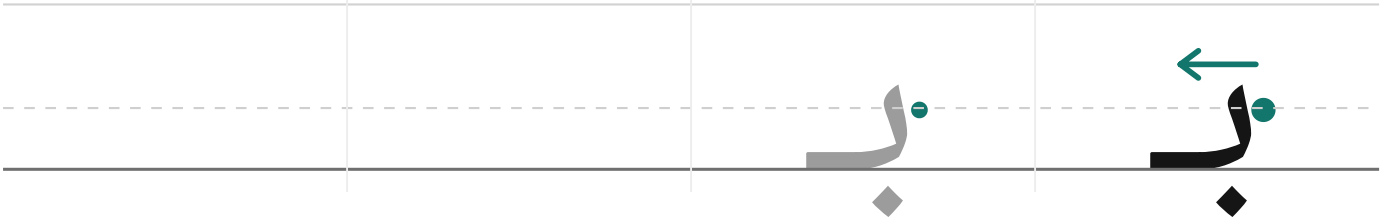
How the pen moves: start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

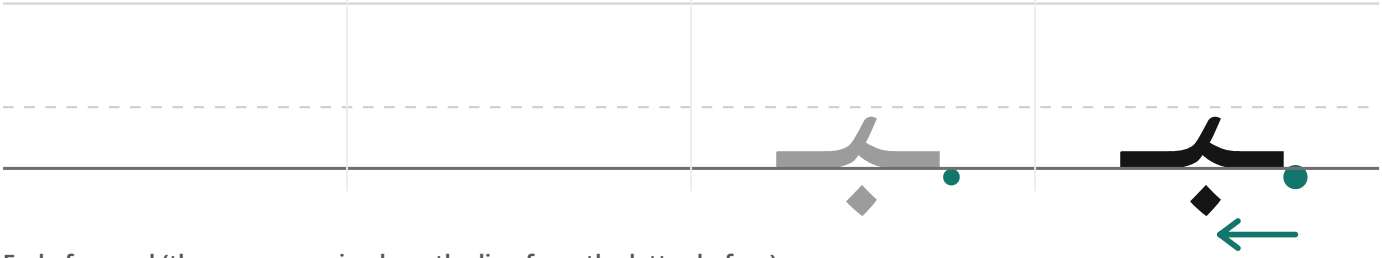
Alone



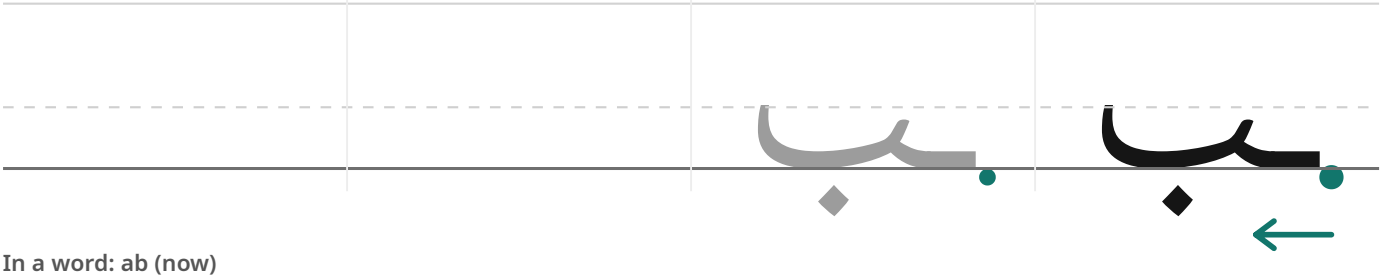
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



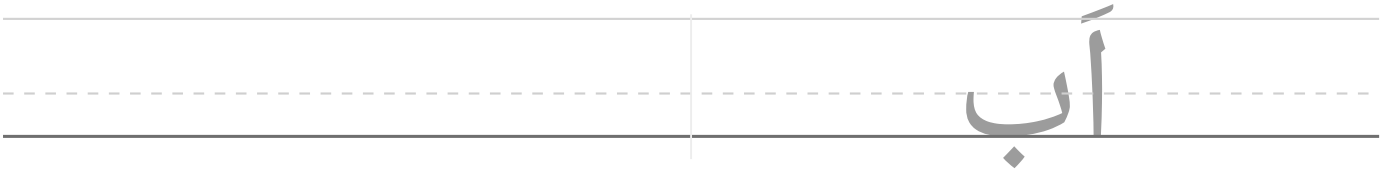
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: ab (now)



Trace and write: kāf

کاف

Name _____ Date _____

kāf کاف



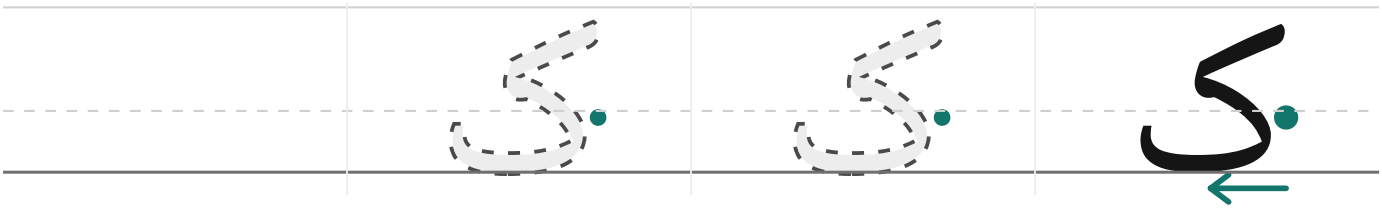
Sound: 'k' in kite

the body only: no dots

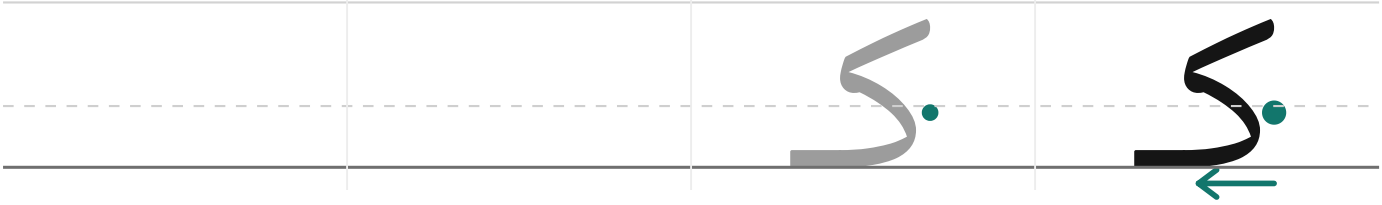
How the pen moves: base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

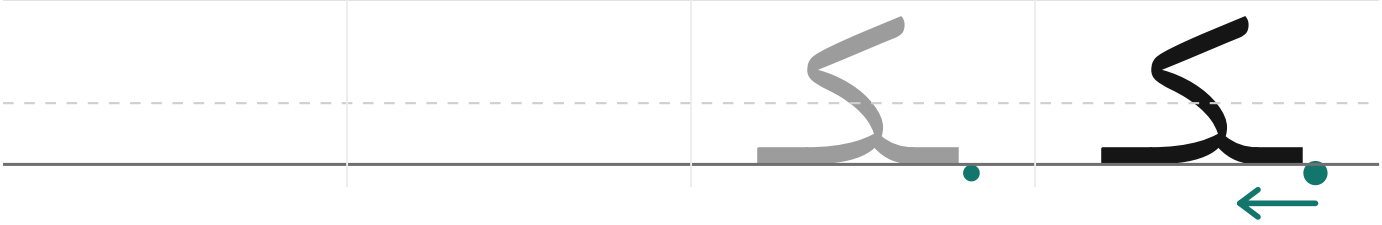
Alone



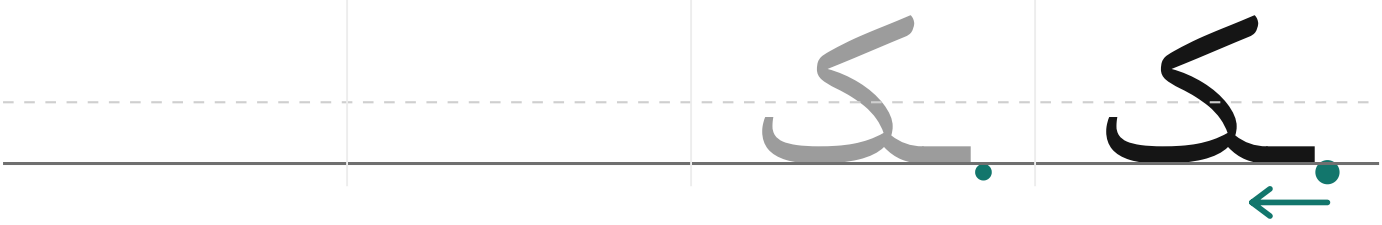
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



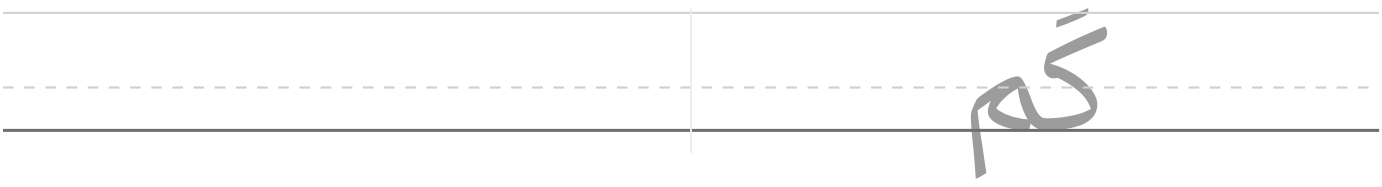
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)

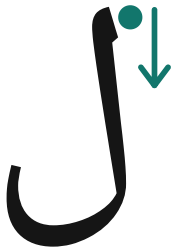


Trace and write: lām

لام

Name _____ Date _____

lām لام



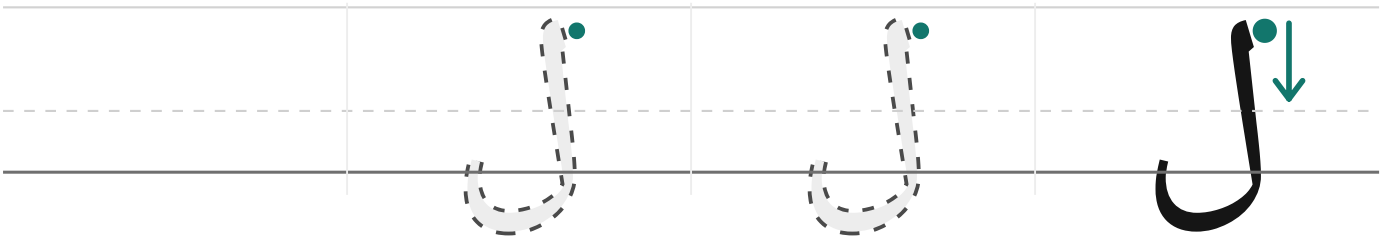
Sound: 'l' in log

the body only: no dots

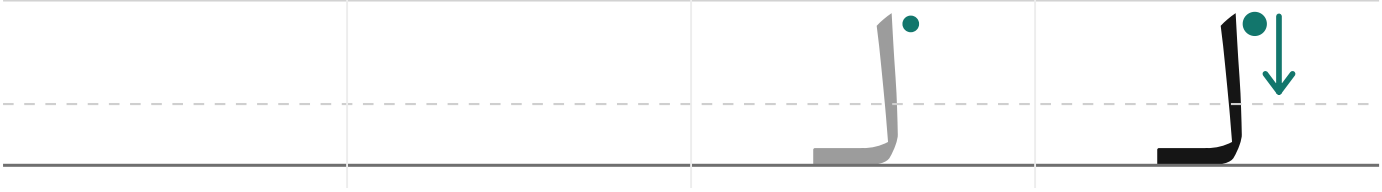
How the pen moves: tall stroke down, curve into the bowl.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

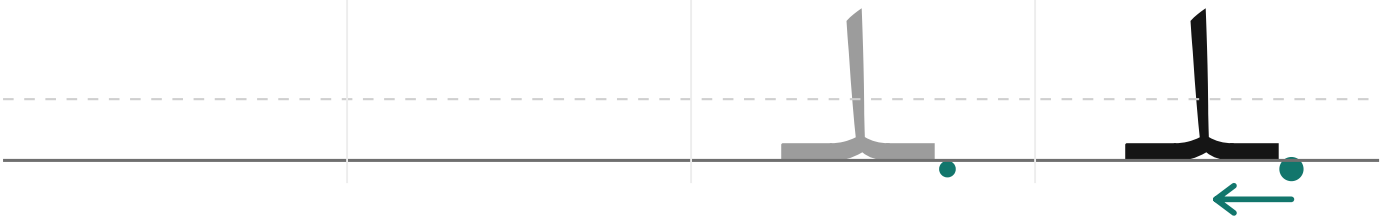
Alone



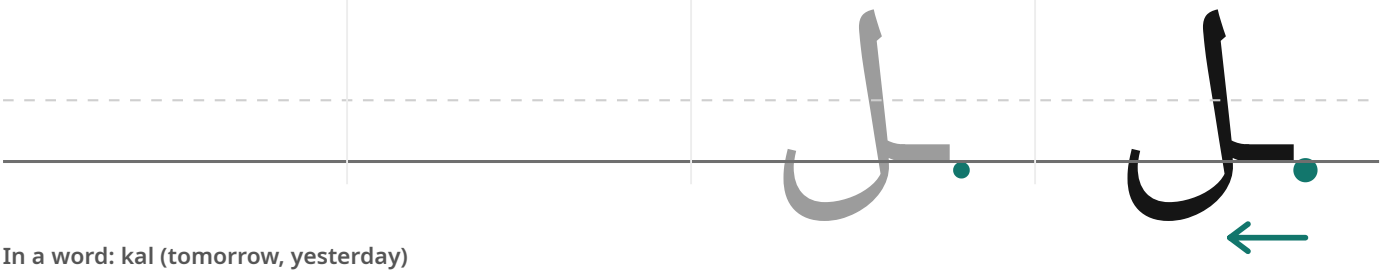
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kal (tomorrow, yesterday)



Trace and write: mīm

میم

Name _____ Date _____

mīm میم

Sound: 'm' in mat

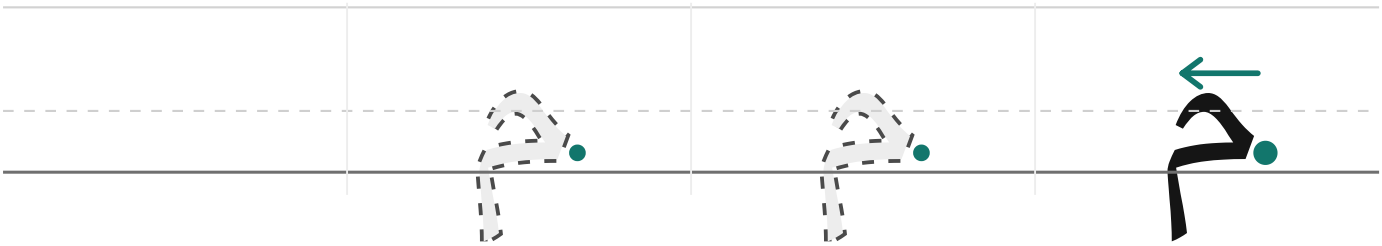
the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: small loop, tail down-left.

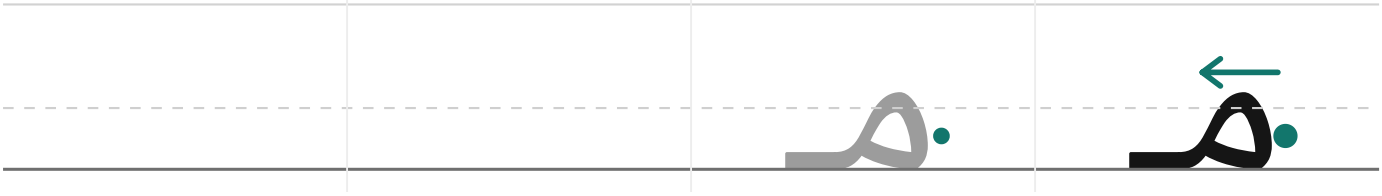
● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.



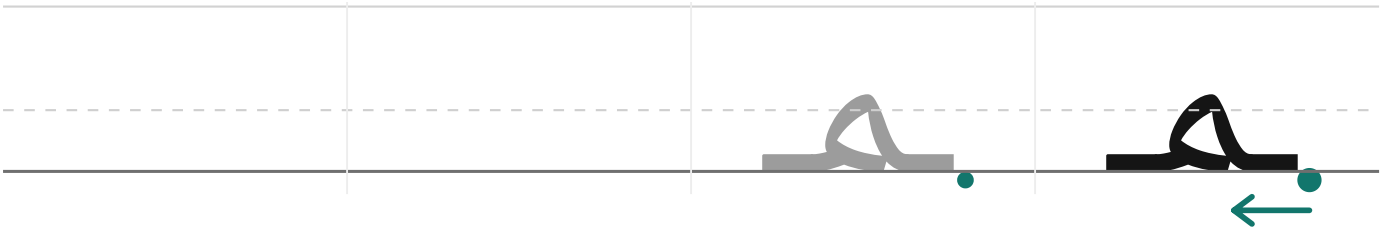
Alone



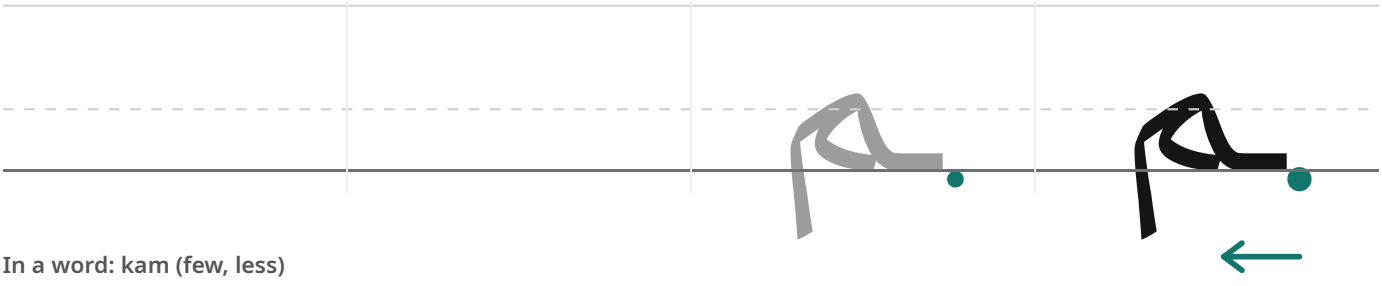
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



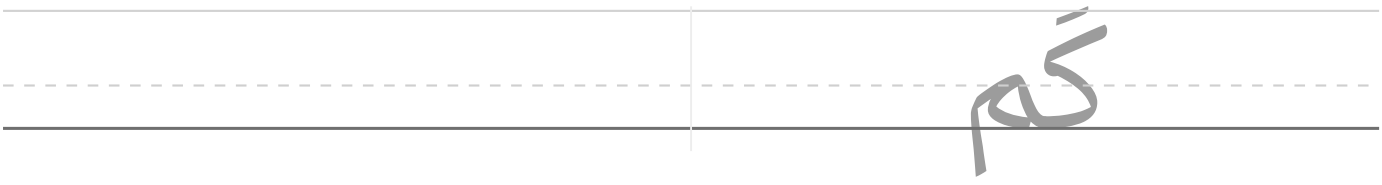
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)



Trace and write: nūn

نون

Name _____ Date _____

nūn نون



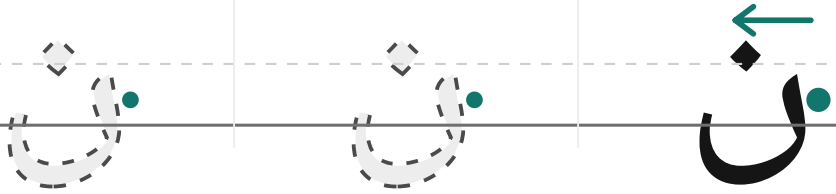
Sound: 'n' in net

step 1: the body | step 2: 1 dot

How the pen moves: deep round bowl; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

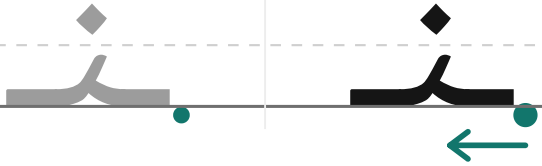
Alone



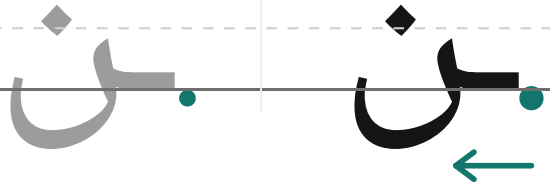
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: nām (name)

نام

Look-alike letters

ملتے جلتے حرف

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Circle every letter that is the same as the big one on the right.**

ک م ا ل ا ن ا	ا
ک ب ب ل ب ن ا	ب
ک ک ل ا ک ن م	ک
ل ک ا ب ل ن م	ل
م م ل ا ک ن ب	م
ب ن ل ن ک ا ن	ن

2 **Count the dots on each letter. Write the letter again in the box with that many dots.**

ل ب ک م ن ا

No dots	1 dot

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

1

ب + ا + ل + کُ + ل

Say: bilkul (absolutely)

بِالکُل

2

م + ا + لِ + ک

Say: mālik (owner)

مالِک

3

لَ + مْ + ب + ا

Say: lambā (long, tall)

4

اِ + مْ + ک + ا + ن

Say: imkān (possibility)

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 **The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.**

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

5

م + ا + ل + کَ

Say: kalām (speech, words)

کَلام

6

ل + ا + م + کَ

Say: kamāl (perfection, skill)

کَمال

7

م + ا + ک + ا + ن

Say: nākām (unsuccessful)

8

ن + کِ + مْ + مُ + ا + ن

Say: nāmumkin (impossible)

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

اِمْکان ○○○	لَمْبا ○○○	مالِک ○○○	بِالکُل ○○○
نامُمْکِن ○○○	ناکام ○○○	کَمال ○○○	کَلام ○○○
کَمان ○○○	نِکالْنا ○○○	مَکان ○○○	کامِل ○○○
کَمانا ○○○	مِلانا ○○○	کَمْبَل ○○○	مِلْنا ○○○
مِلا ○○○	مُلْک ○○○	نام ○○○	کام ○○○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bilkul (absolutely) · mālik (owner) · lambā (long, tall) · imkān (possibility) · kalām (speech, words) · kamāl (perfection, skill) · nākām (unsuccessful) · nāmumkin (impossible) · kāmil (perfect) · makān (house) · nikālnā (to take out) · kamān (bow) · milnā (to meet) · kambal (blanket) · milānā (to mix, join) · kamānā (to earn) · kām (work) · nām (name) · mulk (country) · milā (met, got)

UNIT 1 · READING PRACTICE

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 **Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).**

بال ○○○	بِنا ○○○	مُکَمَّل ○○○	مُمْکِن ○○○
مال ○○○	بَنانا ○○○	ناک ○○○	کالا ○○○
مان ○○○	کان ○○○	نَمَک ○○○	مانْنا ○○○
لانا ○○○	مالا ○○○	اِملا ○○○	کَباب ○○○
مُنّا ○○○	مَنانا ○○○	کَم ○○○	اَب ○○○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bāl (hair) · binā (without) · mukammal (complete) · mumkin (possible) · māl (goods, wealth) · banānā (to make) · nāk (nose) · kālā (black) · mān (pride, honour) · kān (ear) · namak (salt) · mānnā (to accept, obey) · lānā (to bring) · mālā (garland) · imlā (spelling) · kabāb (kebab) · munnā (dear little boy) · manānā (to persuade, celebrate) · kam (few, less) · ab (now)

Read the sentences

جملے پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

2 **Read each line twice. Slide your finger under the words, right to left. Then trace it.**

بابا کا نام کَمال

بابا کا نام کَمال

نانا کا مَکان

نانا کا مَکان

کالا کَمْبَل لانا

کالا کَمْبَل لانا

Read the story

کہانی پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

3 **Read the story. Then ask: who? where? what happened?**

کَمال کا بابا۔ کَمال کا نانا۔ نانا کا مَکان لَمْبا۔ نانا کا کَمْبَل کالا۔ کَمال کا کام: نَمَک لانا۔



Time it: ____ seconds. Words in the story: 19. Words per minute = 19 × 60 ÷ seconds.

For the grown-up: sounds and meanings

Read the lines aloud first, then let the child read them. Ask the three questions after the story.

1. bābā kā nām kamāl - dad's name is Kamal

2. nānā kā makān - grandfather's house

3. kālā kambal lānā - bring the black blanket

Story. kamāl kā bābā. kamāl kā nānā. nānā kā makān lambā. nānā kā kambal kālā. kamāl kā kām: namak lānā.

Meaning. Kamal's dad. Kamal's grandfather. Grandfather's house is long. Grandfather's blanket is black. Kamal's job: bringing salt.

Unit 1 check

جانچ

Name _____ Date _____

A grown-up reads each prompt. No help with the letters. 10 questions, about 10 minutes.

1 Say: “be” ('b' in bat)

ب ن ک م

2 Say: “kāf” ('k' in kite)

ن ل ا ک

3 Say: “lām” ('l' in log)

ا ب م ل

4 How many dots does this letter have?

ن

0 1 2 3

5 Say: “kal” (tomorrow, yesterday)

کَب کَل اَب

6 Say: “milānā” (to mix, join)

مانْنا بَنانا مِلانا

7 Say: “māl” (goods, wealth)

نان مال مِلا

8 Join the letters and write the word. Say: “nāk”.

ک + ا + ن

_____

- -

_____

9 Join the letters and write the word. Say: “lambā”.

لَ + مْ + ب + ا

_____

- -

_____

10 Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلا

☐ right ☐ needs help

Score: _____ / 10 **8 or more: ready for the next unit**

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

Look-alike letters, part 1: circle these (counting from the right)

Letter	Circles
ا	3, 5, 7
ب	3, 5, 6
ک	3, 6, 7
ل	3, 7
م	6, 7
ن	1, 4, 6

Look-alike letters, part 2: the dot boxes

Box	Letters
no dots	ا م ک ل
1 dot	ب ن

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

Join the letters: the words

#	Word	Say / meaning
1	بِالکُل	bilkul (absolutely)
2	مالِک	mālik (owner)
3	لَمْبا	lambā (long, tall)
4	اِمْکان	imkān (possibility)
5	کَلام	kalām (speech, words)
6	کَمال	kamāl (perfection, skill)
7	ناکام	nākām (unsuccessful)
8	نامُمْکِن	nāmumkin (impossible)

Unit 1 check: answer key

Correct answers are circled. If the score is under 8: redo the look-alike sheet and the trace sheet for the letters that were missed, wait a day, try again.

1 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “be” ('b' in bat)

ب ن ک م

2 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “kāf” ('k' in kite)

ن ل ا ک

3 If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter

Say: “lām” ('l' in log)

ا ب م ل

4 If wrong, redo: look-alike sheet, part 2

How many dots does this letter have?

ن

0 1 2 3

5 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “kal” (tomorrow, yesterday)

کَب کَل اَب

6 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “milānā” (to mix, join)

مِلانا بَنانا مانْنا

7 If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice

Say: “māl” (goods, wealth)

نان مال مِلا

8 If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “nāk”.

ک + ا + ن

ناک

9 If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet

Join the letters and write the word. Say: “lambā”.

ا + ب + مْ + لَ

لَمْبا

10 If wrong, redo: reading practice words

Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلا

Answer: milā (met, got)